

LicenseWise – Knowledge-Based License Recommendation System

✔ Successfully loaded **24 licenses** from database.

Answer the questions below to get a license recommendation or check a specific license's compatibility.

 [License Recommendation](#)

 [License Analysis](#)

Project Requirements

Fill out the form below to get personalized license recommendations based on your project's needs.

Distribution & Usage

Will you distribute your software to others?

Distribution means giving copies to other people/organizations

☒ yes

☐ no

☐ skip

Will the software be used over a network (SaaS)?

Network use = users access it via web/API without downloading

☐ yes

☒ no

☐ skip

Is commercial use intended?

Will this be used to make money or in a commercial product?

☒ yes

☐ no

☐ skip

Do you need patent protection?

Patent grants protect you from patent claims

☐ yes

☒ no

☐ skip

Do you want derivatives to remain open source (copyleft)?

Copyleft ensures modifications stay open source

☒ yes

☐ no

☐ skip

License Preferences

Want weak copyleft (library level)?

Library can be used in proprietary software

☒ yes

☐ no

☐ skip

Want file-level copyleft?

Only modified files must remain open

☐ yes

☒ no

☐ skip

Freedom to relicense derivatives?

Can derivatives use different licenses?

☐ yes

☒ no

☐ skip

Project type

☐ Software

☒ Library

☐ Content

☐ skip

Linking type (if library)

☒ Dynamic

☐ Static

☐ skip

Will you modify the library?

☐ yes

☒ no

☐ skip

Dedicate to public domain?

☐ yes

☒ no

☐ skip

Prefer simple permissive license?

☐ yes

☒ no

☐ skip

Academic project?	Mixed open/proprietary codebase?	Concerned about legal recognition?
☒ yes	☒ yes	☒ yes
☐ no	☐ no	☐ no
☐ skip	☐ skip	☐ skip

 [Get Recommendation](#)

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LICENSEWISE FINAL REPORT

✓ RECOMMENDED LICENSES: • Apache-2.0 • GPL-3.0 • LGPL-2.1 • LGPL-3.0 • MPL-2.0

✗ ELIMINATED LICENSES: • CC-BY-NC-4.0

⚠ WARNINGS: • Unlicense: Not recognized in all jurisdictions. Consider CC0. • AGPL-3.0: Strongest copyleft – affects distribution AND network use.

🎯 CONFIDENCE: HIGH (provided 16/16 facts)

HOW THE ENGINE REACHED THIS CONCLUSION:

- Step 1: ✓ recommend_Apache_if_commercial Action: RECOMMEND Because you answered: • Saas: No • Commercial Use: Yes • Need Patent Protection: No • Want Copyleft: Yes • Want Weak Copyleft: Yes • Want File Copyleft: No • Wants Relicense: No • Project Type: library • Linking Type: dynamic • Modify Library: No • Want Public Domain: No • Want Simple Permissive: No • Academic Project: Yes • Mixed Open Proprietary: Yes • Concerned About Legal Recognition: Yes • Closed Source: No Why: Apache-2.0 permits commercial use and includes patent protections.
- Step 2: ⚠ warn_Unlicense_jurisdiction Action: WARN Because you answered: • Saas: No • Commercial Use: Yes • Need Patent Protection: No • Want Copyleft: Yes • Want Weak Copyleft: Yes • Want File Copyleft: No • Wants Relicense: No • Project Type: library • Linking Type: dynamic • Modify Library: No • Want Public Domain: No • Want Simple Permissive: No • Academic Project: Yes • Mixed Open Proprietary: Yes • Concerned About Legal Recognition: Yes • Closed Source: No Why: Public domain dedication may not be legally valid worldwide.
- Step 3: ✓ recommend_GPL_if_copyleft Action: RECOMMEND Because you answered: • Saas: No • Commercial Use: Yes • Need Patent Protection: No • Want Copyleft: Yes • Want Weak Copyleft: Yes • Want File Copyleft: No • Wants Relicense: No • Project Type: library • Linking Type: dynamic • Modify Library: No • Want Public Domain: No • Want Simple Permissive: No • Academic Project: Yes • Mixed Open Proprietary: Yes • Concerned About Legal Recognition: Yes • Closed Source: No Why: GPL-3.0 ensures distributed derivatives remain open source.
- Step 4: ⚠ warn_AGPL_strongest_copyleft Action: WARN Because you answered: • Saas: No • Commercial Use: Yes • Need Patent Protection: No • Want Copyleft: Yes • Want Weak Copyleft: Yes • Want File Copyleft: No • Wants Relicense: No • Project Type: library • Linking Type: dynamic • Modify Library: No • Want Public Domain: No • Want Simple Permissive: No • Academic Project: Yes • Mixed Open Proprietary: Yes • Concerned About Legal Recognition: Yes • Closed Source: No Why: AGPL is very restrictive; many companies prohibit its use.
- Step 5: ✓ recommend_LGPL_for_library Action: RECOMMEND Because you answered: • Saas: No • Commercial Use: Yes • Need Patent Protection: No • Want Copyleft: Yes • Want Weak Copyleft: Yes • Want File Copyleft: No •

Wants Relicense: No • Project Type: library • Linking Type: dynamic • Modify Library: No • Want Public Domain: No • Want Simple Permissive: No • Academic Project: Yes • Mixed Open Proprietary: Yes • Concerned About Legal Recognition: Yes • Closed Source: No Why: LGPL keeps the library open but allows proprietary linking.

Step 6:  recommend_MPL_if_mixed_codebase Action: RECOMMEND Because you answered: • Saas: No • Commercial Use: Yes • Need Patent Protection: No • Want Copyleft: Yes • Want Weak Copyleft: Yes • Want File Copyleft: No • Wants Relicense: No • Project Type: library • Linking Type: dynamic • Modify Library: No • Want Public Domain: No • Want Simple Permissive: No • Academic Project: Yes • Mixed Open Proprietary: Yes • Concerned About Legal Recognition: Yes • Closed Source: No Why: MPL-2.0 is ideal for mixed open/proprietary codebases.

Step 7:  eliminate_CC_BY_NC_if_commercial Action: ELIMINATE Because you answered: • Saas: No • Commercial Use: Yes • Need Patent Protection: No • Want Copyleft: Yes • Want Weak Copyleft: Yes • Want File Copyleft: No • Wants Relicense: No • Project Type: library • Linking Type: dynamic • Modify Library: No • Want Public Domain: No • Want Simple Permissive: No • Academic Project: Yes • Mixed Open Proprietary: Yes • Concerned About Legal Recognition: Yes • Closed Source: No Why: CC-BY-NC-4.0 prohibits commercial use.

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 **DISCLAIMER:** This is not legal advice. Consult a lawyer for production use.

 **EXPLANATION:** How did the engine get this result?

The engine RECOMMENDED licenses because:

1. Apache-2.0 permits commercial use and includes patent protections.
2. GPL-3.0 ensures distributed derivatives remain open source.
3. LGPL keeps the library open but allows proprietary linking.
4. MPL-2.0 is ideal for mixed open/proprietary codebases.

The engine ELIMINATED licenses because: 7. CC-BY-NC-4.0 prohibits commercial use.

The engine WARNED because: 2. Public domain dedication may not be legally valid worldwide. 4. AGPL is very restrictive; many companies prohibit its use.

Each step above was triggered by matching your answers against the rule base.

 **Disclaimer:** This tool is for educational purposes only and does not constitute legal advice. Always consult a qualified intellectual property lawyer for production use.

Database: 24 licenses loaded from .JSON